

Dekel Riess

Game Designer — Systems, Economy & Progression

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Based in Israel · EU citizen — authorized to work across the EU, no sponsorship required · Open to relocation & remote

PROFILE

Systems and economy designer for free-to-play mobile, studying Game Design and Development at Tiltan College. I design the mechanics, economies, and progression that make a game click — and I code them myself in C#/Unity, so every design is tested in a real build, not just on paper. Four finished games across four genres including a shipped physical board game, two mobile titles in active development with full loops playable and playtested, and a decade of live Minecraft servers behind them — one peaking at ~300 concurrent players, one original concept acquired by a studio.

CORE SKILLS

Design: Systems Design · Economy & Balance · Progression & Meta · F2P Monetization · Level Design · UX · Playtesting & Iteration · Game Design Documents (GDDs)

Engines & Code: Unity · C# · MonoGame · Android · Python · expanding into Unreal, Godot & C++

Tools: Figma · Git · Aseprite · Paint.NET · Tiled · Visual Studio / Rider · Adobe Premiere Pro

Languages: Hebrew (Native) · English (Fluent) · Japanese (Conversational)

SELECTED PROJECTS

Rest in Profit — Mobile Collection / Auto-Battler

Solo · Unity/Android · In Development

Cozy-macabre necromancer game: a Disco-Zoo dig loop feeding a role-based dungeon defense, tied together by one economy. Full loop playable — a capped 25-relic trade-off loadout, nine data-authored abilities, simulated offline raids, rewarded-video-only monetization. Playtesting drove the key calls: diagnosed a “balance” failure as a positioning-AI gap and the same squad held ten waves longer; answered three feature requests with one tutorial director instead of three new systems.

Dogfight Evolution — Hybrid-Casual Vertical Shooter

Solo · Unity · In Development

Fuel replaces HP as the run clock — no death screen, no fail state, one resource carrying pacing, tension, and session length. Every shop stat is hard-capped so upgrades stay a decision, and the six split into combat and economy stats so grinding income never scales difficulty. Passed a cold 10-second clarity test with fresh testers.

TiltanTale — Turn-Based Bullet-Hell RPG

Lead Gameplay Designer · C#/MonoGame

Undertale-inspired RPG with an engine-less, code-authored battle framework: 15+ hand-built boss encounters, each with unique attack patterns and spare/defeat outcomes, all plugging into one scalable system. Two-person team; released on itch.io.

Dekelatro — Poker Roguelike

Solo · C# · Graded 100/100

Engineered from scratch in ~2,250 lines of C# with no engine or card library: a polymorphic joker system, a scoring pipeline, and a weighted-RNG shop, plus a full economy rebalance.

Trials of the Dungeon — Co-op Board Game

Game Designer & Co-Director

Cooperative dungeon-crawl shipped as a physical product. Designed combat, economy, and progression; wrote the 14-page rulebook; ran 5 structured playtests and rebalanced core systems from the data.

Also: Brave the Wilderness — mobile survival, a “two-in, one-out” merge rule scaling into a 117-item, 5-tier crafting economy. · RunicRPG — 2.5D action RPG, playable core loop (XP, rarity drops, equipment scrolling, rune skill tree). · Dice Bound — idle battler; led design on a 3-person team, full GDD and team post-mortem.

EXPERIENCE

Minecraft Level & World Designer — Independent

2014 – 2025

Designed six multiplayer servers end to end — world layout, zone gating, economy, and progression — and authored 100% of the custom textures, each backed by a full design doc. One peaked at ~300 concurrent players; one original concept was acquired by a studio.

Game Designer & Community Manager — Yourpixel

2017 – 2020

Ran a Minecraft server end to end; designed game modes, quests, and HUD/GUI for retention, and recruited and led a content team. Grew concurrent players from ~30 to ~200; promoted to senior manager.

Content Creator — YouTube

2012 – 2023

Scripted, filmed, and edited long-form video for 20,000+ subscribers — the foundation of the trailer and devlog work I do today.

Fighter Jet Technician — Israeli Air Force (Reservist)

2020 – Present

Aircraft maintenance and troubleshooting under strict safety protocols. Squadron Excellence Certificate, 2021.

Aircraft Mechanic — El Al Airlines

2023 – 2024

Maintenance and inspections across four commercial aircraft types under tight international turnaround windows.

EDUCATION

Game Design & Development — Tiltan College of Visual Design and Communication

2025 – 2028 (Expected)

Coursework: C#, Object-Oriented Programming, Game Design.

Full Bagrut (Israeli Matriculation) — Ankori North High School

2015 – 2018